

Add to that there is no royalty or fee for using the PNG. Recently, CompuServe (the developer of GIF) announced that it would charge a fee on the usage of its GIF format. You can try to save your images as PNG in place of GIF or JPEG - see if the quality vs file size is acceptable and take your own call!

9.4 Uncompressed Formats - TIFF

TIFF is an acronym for Tag(ged) Image File Format. It was developed by Aldus and Microsoft Corp. to provide a common format for scanners to save images. The specification was owned by Aldus, which has now merged with Adobe Systems, Incorporated., which hence owns the copyright for the TIFF specification. TIFF is a versatile and flexible format owing to its ability to store image data in an uncompressed raw format or to use other compression formats such as JPEG to store with a lesser file size. If a JPEG compression is used, then what is the need for TIFF? The advantage is that TIFF can store different layers that you might create in the course of editing. Hence it is easy for anyone to revisit the document using any imaging tool and work on the file. This eliminates the need for all the persons working on an image to use the same software for editing layers. For example, a designer working with GIMP or Paintshop can save his work as a TIFF and share it with someone who uses Photoshop, while not losing the layer information.

TIFF can support arbitrary number of bits per pixel ranging from 1 to 64 unlike other formats which support only 2^n like 4, 8, 16 etc. The colour schemes supported include CMYK, RGB, Grayscale, etc.

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Saving for Print

- If you wish to print your image on another machine which may not have Photoshop installed, you can save the image in a TIFF format (uncompressed). Try as much as possible not to use any compression unless you are hard pressed for space.